

Lean Management (and Lego Simulation)

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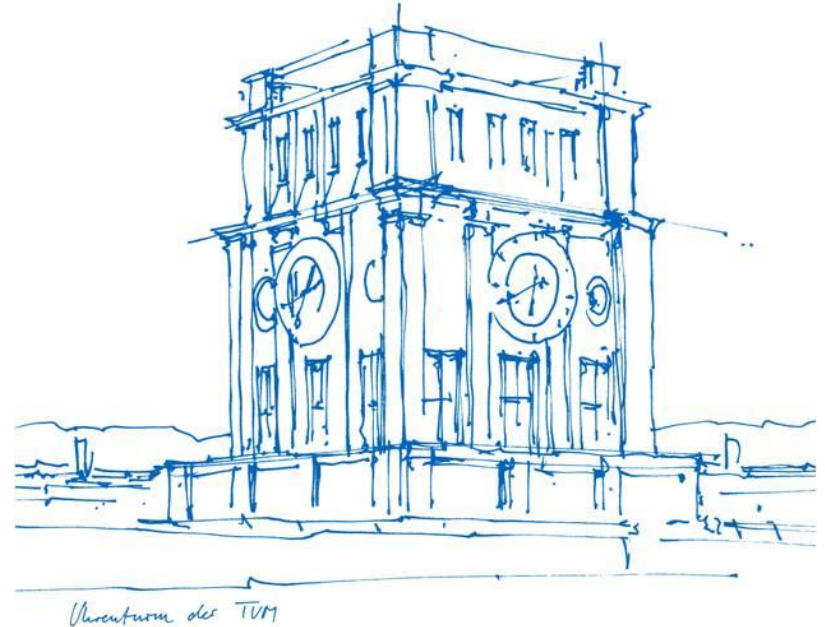
Examiner: Prof. Dr. David Wuttke

Technische Universität München

School of Management

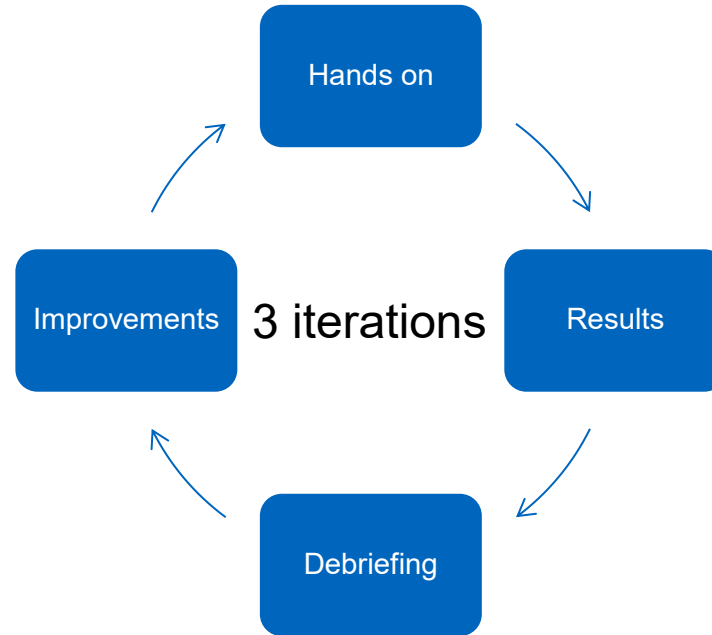
Campus Heilbronn

Heilbronn, 2026



Lean Lego Simulation

Simulation



Your main product

44 bricks
per glider



1 glider sold
= \$ 10,000

1 brick = \$ 100

“Sly Slider” introduced in 2009



Margin per glider = \$ 5,600

“Icky Ice Glider” introduced in 2011



Margin per glider = \$ 5,600

“Gliderlinski” introduced 2013



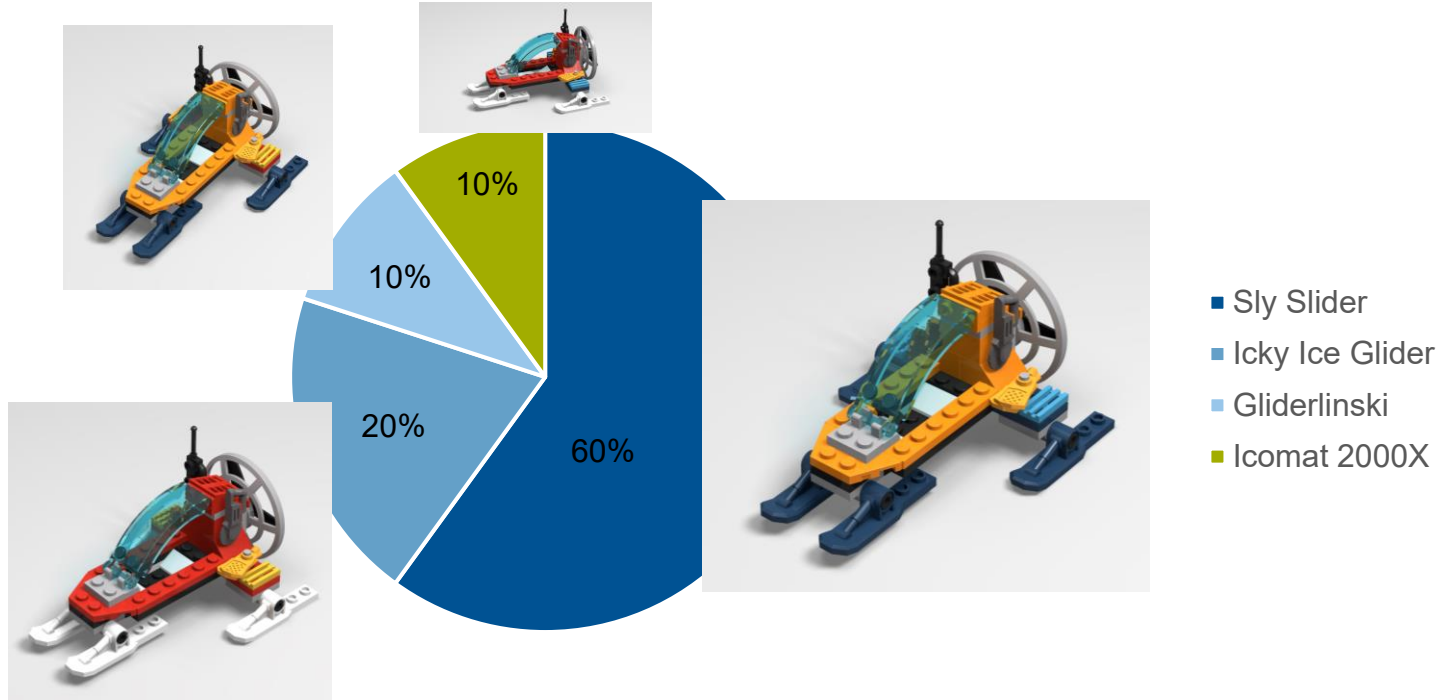
Margin per glider = \$ 5,600

“Icomat 2000X” introduced 2016



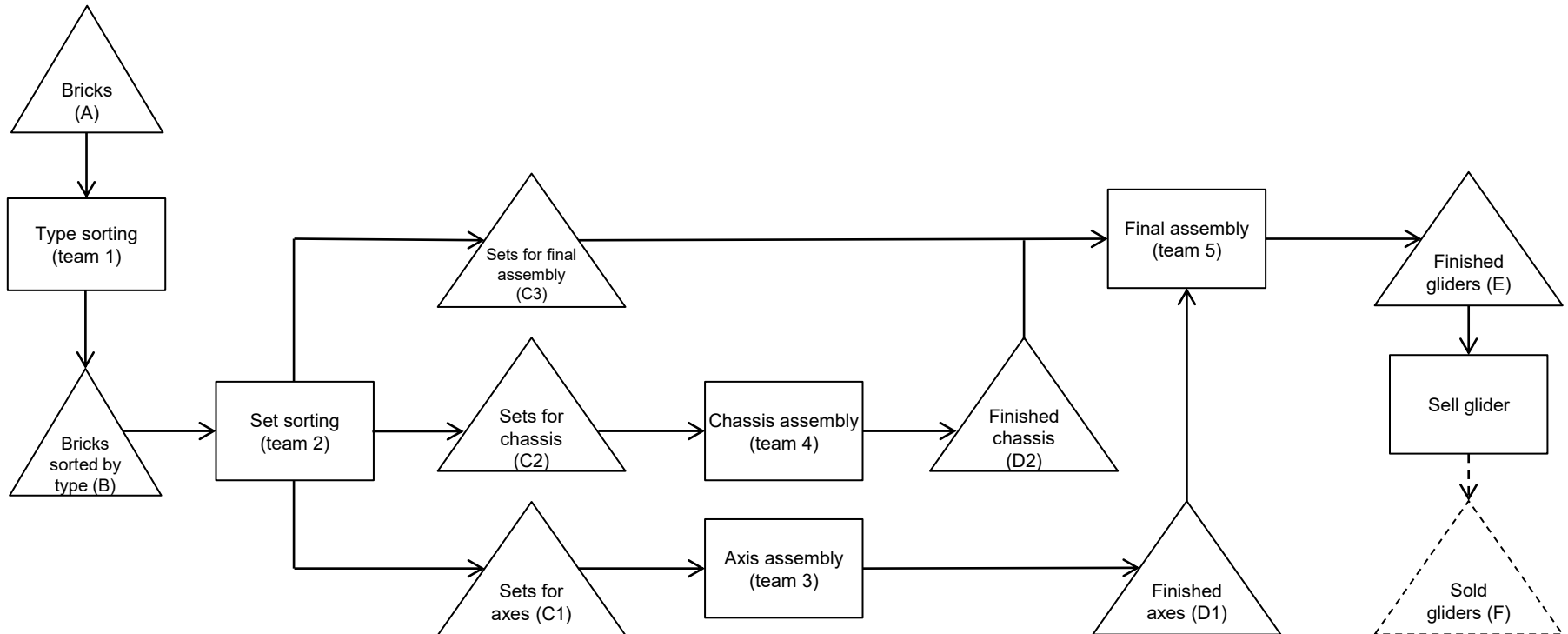
Margin per glider = \$ 5,600

Past sales (2018)



Iteration 1

Iteration 1: Conventional Production Process



Sequence

Taking inventory (assess status quo)

1st production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

2nd production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

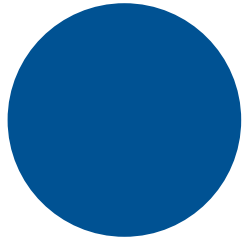
3rd production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

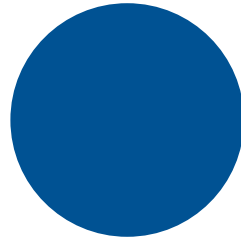
4th production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

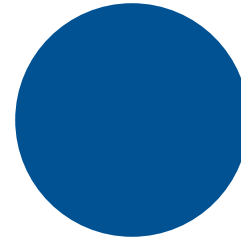
Timer (3 minutes)



Minute 1



Minute 2



Minute 3

Start!

please stop producing!

Debrief: Iteration 1

Did you observe *muda*?

Muda or the 7 Wastes of Manufacturing

Overproduction ahead of demand

Unnecessary transport of materials

Over-processing of parts

Inventories above the minimum

Unnecessary movements by employees during their work

Production of defective parts

Waiting

Push versus Pull

Push



Pull



Kanban (queue limiter)



Kanban



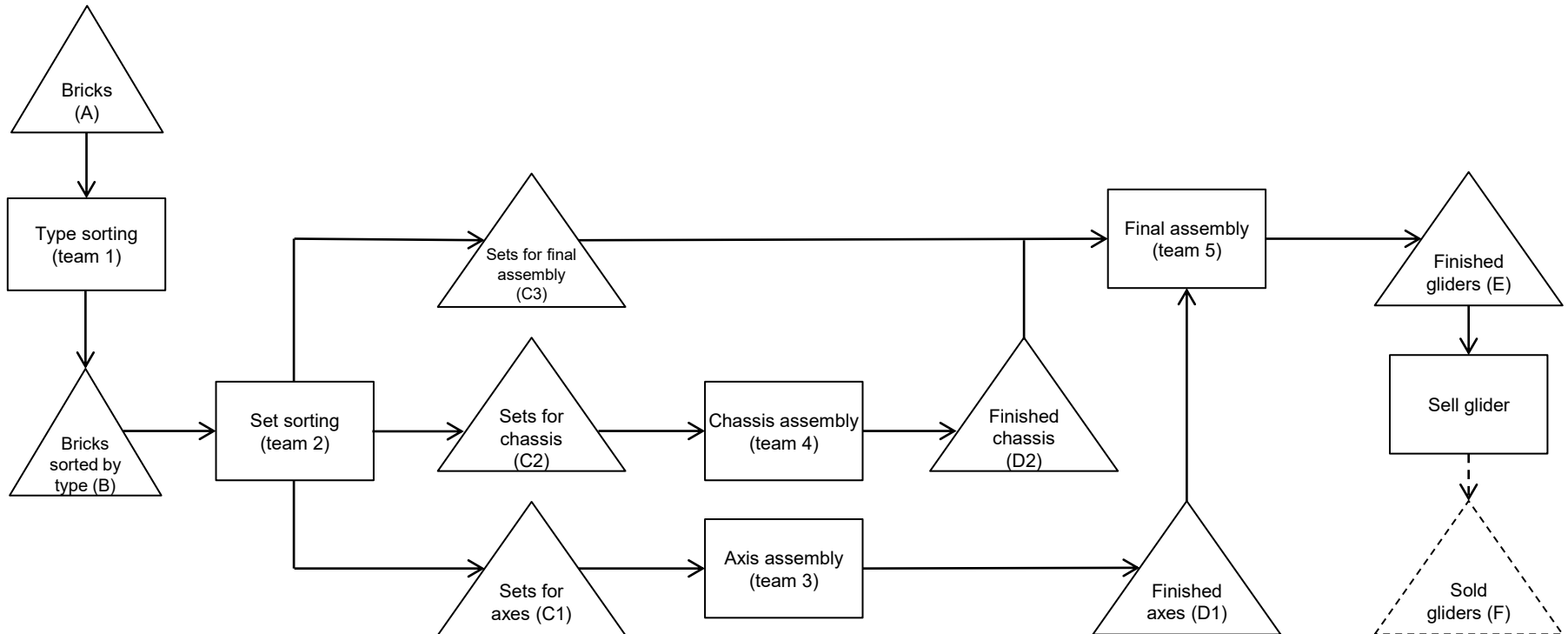
Kanban in practice



https://www.wuerth-industrie.com/web/de/wuerthindustrie/teile_management/kanban/kanbansysteme_kanbanprinzip/systeme_prinzip_kanban.php

Iteration 2: Pull with Kanban

Iteration 2: Pull with Kanban



Sequence

Taking inventory (assess status quo)

1st production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

2nd production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

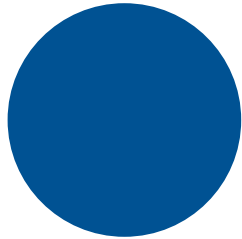
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Taking inventory

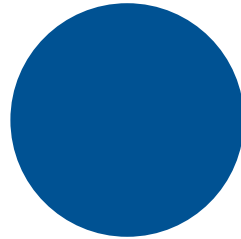
4th production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

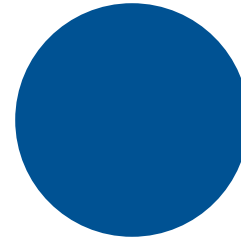
Timer (3 minutes)



Minute 1



Minute 2



Minute 3

Start!

please stop producing!

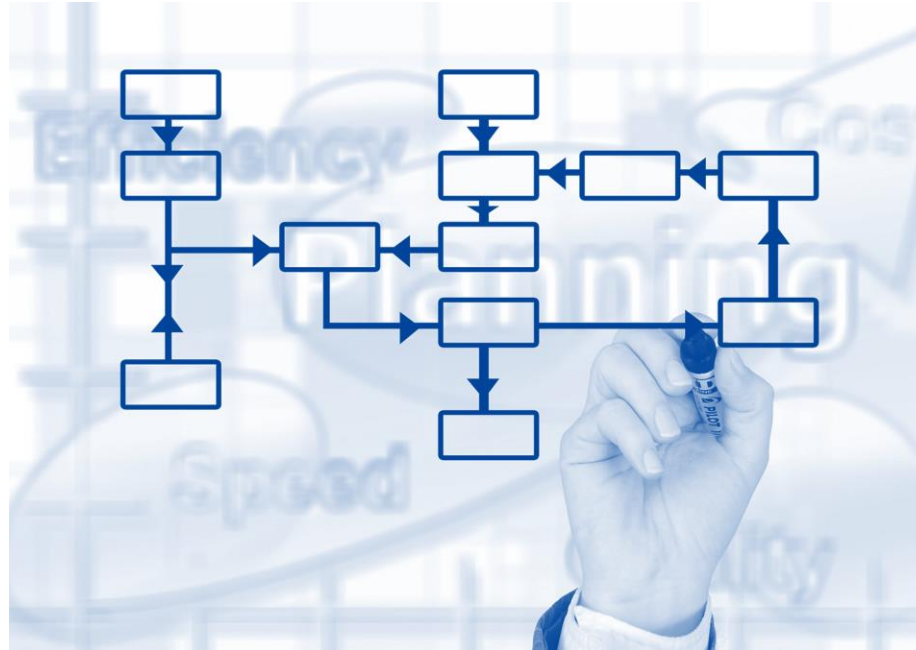
Debrief: Iteration 2

What went wrong?

Value



Value Stream



Flow



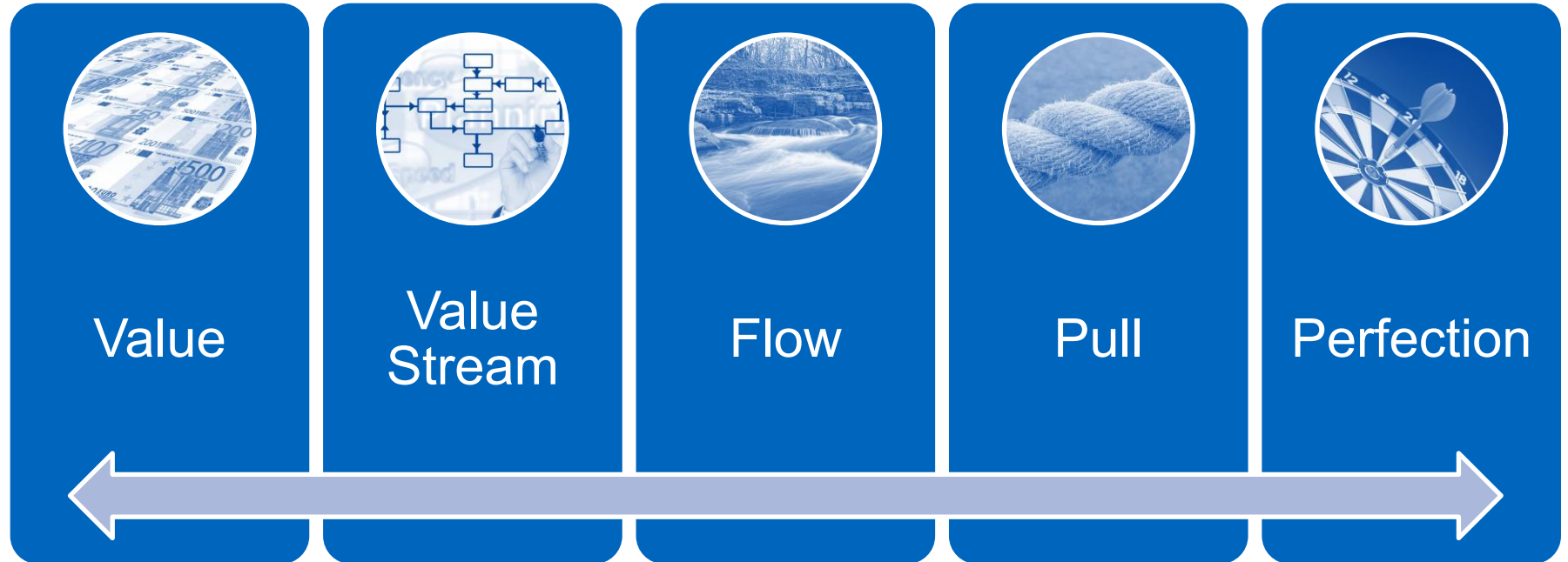
Pull



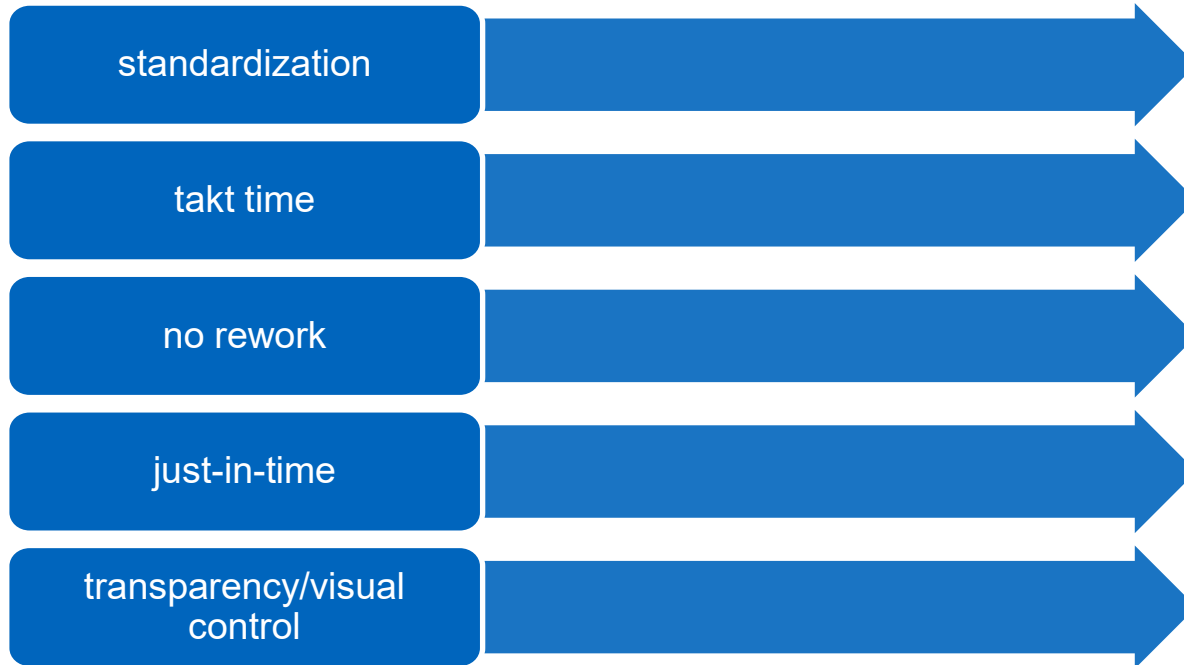
Perfection



Five Elements of Lean Management



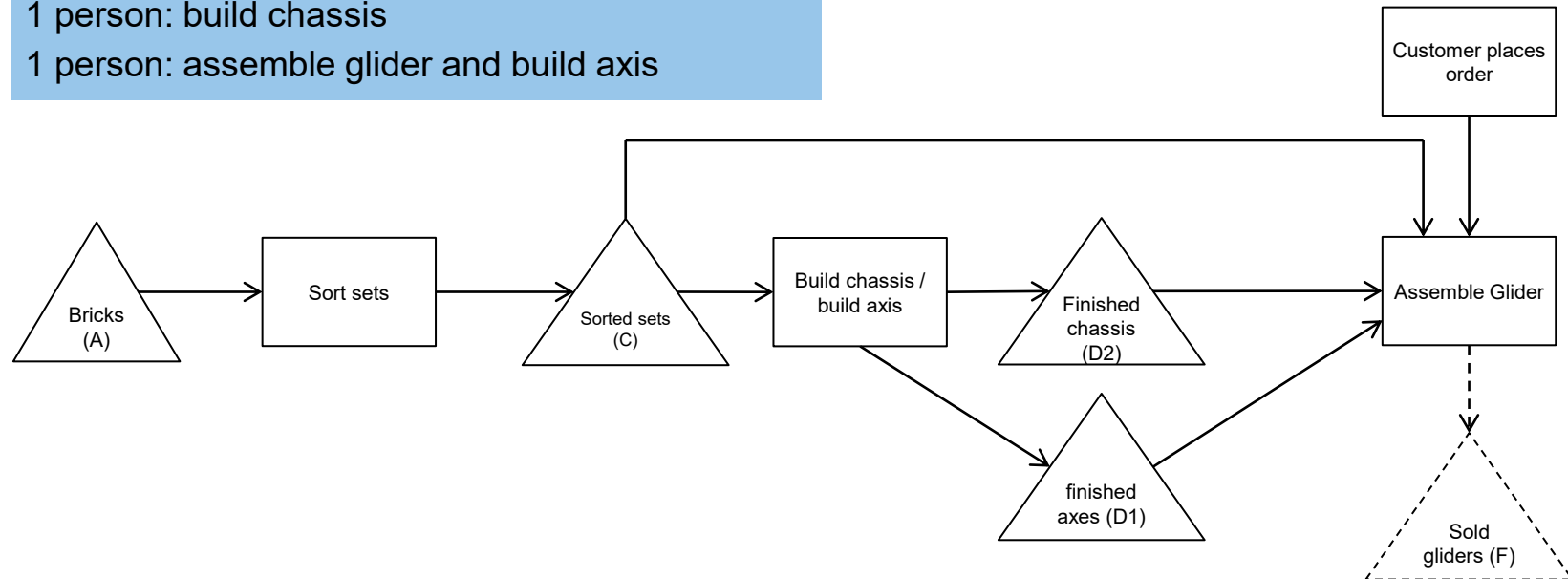
Five Concepts of Flow



Iteration 3: Manufacturing Cells

Iteration 3: Manufacturing Cells

1 person: sort sets
1 person: build chassis
1 person: assemble glider and build axis



Sequence

Taking inventory (assess status quo)

1st production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

2nd production run: 3 minutes production (1 minute corresponds to 1 week in real)

Taking inventory

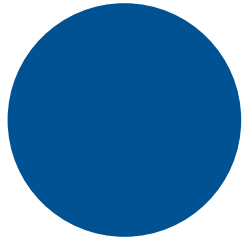
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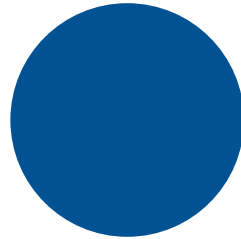
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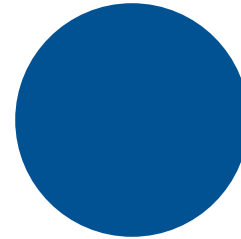
Timer (3 minutes)



Minute 1



Minute 2



Minute 3

Start!

please stop producing!

Debrief: Iteration 3

What's next?

Central Concepts of Lean Management

Kaikaku

Kaizen

Muda (Waste)

- overproduction ahead of demand
- unnecessary transport of materials
- over-processing of parts
- inventories above the minimum
- unnecessary movements by employees during their work
- production of defective parts
- waiting

Poka-yoke

Bonus round #4

How lean can you get?

Bonus round – How lean can you get?

